

INNERSOURCE COMMONS

Gathering Organizer

Guide / 2026 and beyond

Everything you need to plan, host, and share an
InnerSource Gathering in your local community.

innersourcecommons.org



Overview

An InnerSource Gathering is a local, community-driven event where practitioners come together to share how they're applying open-source principles inside their organizations — in person or hybrid.

Gatherings are smaller and more focused than global InnerSource Summit. They're the place where real conversations happen — about tooling, culture change, internal contribution models, failure stories, and what's actually working in a local context

This program empowers individuals in the InnerSource ecosystem to host a local in-person or hybrid gathering around a shared interest.



Local

Community-led



Trusted

Peer exchange



Practical

Actionable takeaways



Connected

Global network

Benefits of Organizing a Gathering



Credibility & recognition

Establish yourself as an InnerSource leader in your community.



Cross-organization collaboration

Build alignment with peers working on similar challenges.



Strategic influence

Shape how InnerSource practice evolves in your region.



Leverage for internal change

Use the event to accelerate InnerSource adoption at your own org.



Earn an Organizer badge

Get formally recognized by the InnerSource Commons Foundation.

Benefits to Participants



Practitioner-grade insights

Learn from peers actively implementing InnerSource in real organizations.



Benchmarking across organizations

Compare approaches, maturity levels, and trade-offs across industries.



Actionable takeaways

Leave with concrete patterns, tools, and practices you can apply to your context.



Trusted peer exchange

Discuss challenges, failures, and constraints in a candid, high-trust setting.



Lasting peer connections

Build relationships that enable continued learning and collaboration beyond the event.

Gathering Guidelines for Organizers

At InnerSource Commons, your Gathering planning begins with a GitHub Issue. The issue template is your working checklist from day one through post-event reporting – it tracks required tasks, key milestones, and the Foundation touchpoints along the way.

Inside you'll find: the full pre- and post-event checklist • required Foundation touchpoints • milestone markers for the Marketing WG • the Essential Three principles every organizer commits to.



Check out the general guidelines on organizing

We recommend that you review this [.md file](#) on a more indepth guideline for organizing a Gathering.

Getting Started

1

Get in touch with the Foundation

Let us know you'd like to host a Gathering by opening a new [GitHub Issue](#) using the 'Organizing an InnerSource Gathering' template. Please do this at least 8 weeks before your planned event date (10+ weeks recommended).

2

Acknowledgement & kickoff call

You'll get an acknowledgement email from the team, and we'll set up a short video call if needed to align on your vision.

3

Follow the organizer documentation

Use the insights and best practices in [this guide](#) – along with the linked issue template, to plan and run your gathering end-to-end.

Organizer Responsibilities



Program & Logistics

- Venue selection and setup
- Agenda design, speaker coordination, run-of-show
- On-the-ground logistics: check-in, timekeeping, A/V
- Ensure accessibility basics (venue, captioning, dietary)



Brand & Compliance

- Use approved Gathering brand assets
- Run any sponsorship or endorsement past the Foundation
- Enforce the Foundation's [Code of Conduct](#) at the event
- Be DEI-conscious in every decision you make



Post-Event

- Submit a post-event report. What might be included:
 - What kind of event was it?
 - How engaged were the participants and DEI efforts.
 - What did your community learn?
 - Tips for future organizers
- Share post-event photos and videos
- Tag ISC in your thank-you / recap posts

The Essential Three (3)

While this is your event, these three things are dear to us to maintain the InnerSource Commons community standards:

1

Keep DEI in mind

Be DEI conscious in every decision you make: From speaker selection to venue accessibility, catering, scheduling, data collection, and language, keep diversity, equity, and inclusion at the heart of your planning.

2

Represent ISC with care

Use approved branding, follow the Code of Conduct, and run any sponsorship or endorsement past the Foundation.

3

Post-event report

Please write a brief report after the event to help future organizers.

Foundation Responsibilities



Branding & Communications

- Promote pre- and post-event on Foundation channels (calendar, website, newsletter, socials)
- Review any use of ISC logos or assets used
- Provide guidance as needed



Logistics & Registration

- Handle event registration via the Foundation Eventbrite platform
- Prioritize local platforms in unique cases where needed
- Provide an @innersourcecommons.org email for attendee communications (if needed)



Community Support

- Connect you with potential speakers (we don't manage your selection)
- At your request, we can ship some merch (stickers) to you
- Showcase your gathering to inspire future organizers

Pre-Event Timeline – Part 1

Owner	Action	When
Organizer	Request to host an InnerSource Gathering via the GitHub Issue template – click 'New Issue', pick 'Organizing an InnerSource Gathering', and fill in the details.	75 days
ISC Foundation	- Gathering approval - Set up a call with organizer to align on deliverables and address concerns	70 days
Organizer & ISC Foundation	Confirm all core details: event date, venue, v1 speakers list, agenda, ticketing decision, sponsors (if any)	60 days
ISC Foundation & Organizer	- Set up the event registration page - Provide promotional material - Add event to the Gatherings website - Announcement on Foundation channels - Test feedback form URL/QR for event day display	30 days

Pre-Event Timeline – Part 2

Owner	Action	When
Organizer & ISC Foundation	■ Complete any remaining action items ■ Reminder sent to participants	7 days
ISC Foundation	■ Final reminder sent to participants	1 day



Event Day

Lead your community gathering. Capture the energy. Connect people. Enjoy the moment you've created.

Post-Event Timeline

Owner	Action	When
Organizer	■ Send list of attendees to the Foundation ■ Post thank-you messages and tag ISC	1 day
ISC Foundation	■ Send post-event feedback form to attendees via Eventbrite ■ Update the Gatherings website	3 days
ISC Foundation	■ Share feedback survey results with organizers ■ Send a thank-you email ■ Award Gathering Organizer badge	2 weeks
Organizer	■ Reflect on the event and write up a post-event report	4 weeks
ISC Foundation & Organizer	■ Promote the report on Foundation channels ■ Submit a PR to add the report to the Gatherings website	5 weeks

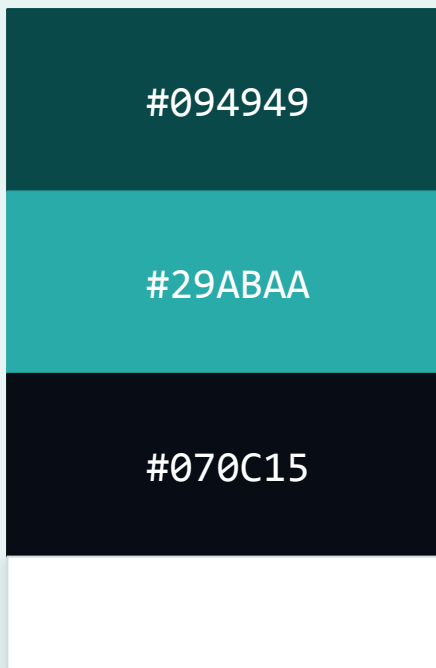
ISC Brand Colors

The ISC Palette

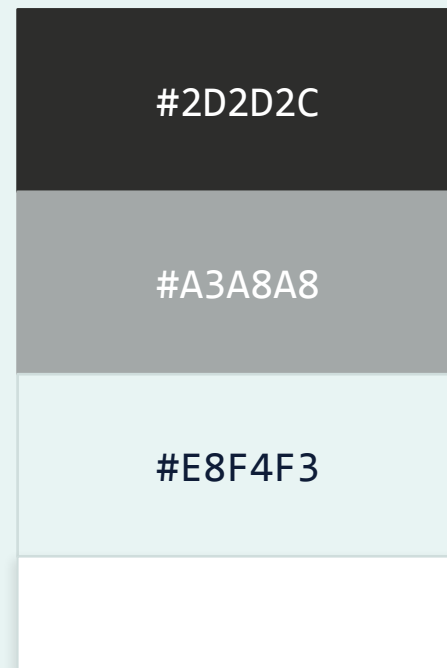
When creating graphics or printed materials for your Gathering that carry the InnerSource Commons brand, please use the primary and secondary colors shown here. Black or white can be used freely for text overlaid on these colors.

NOTE: *This is a guide, not a restriction – the palette applies specifically to anything that represents ISC officially. Your Gathering's own materials can use whatever complements your local/regional identity or event theme.*

PRIMARY COLORS



SECONDARY COLORS



ISC Brand Font

PT Sans

PT Sans is the official InnerSource Commons brand font. Use it for headings, body copy, and any printed or digital material that represents ISC officially.

NOTE: *You're not restricted to PT Sans for your Gathering's own materials — use whatever pairs well with your local/regional identity or event theme. This guide only applies when you're using ISC assets.*

A Available free from Google Fonts → fonts.google.com/specimen/PT+Sans

Aa

PT Sans

ABCDEFGHIJKLM

NOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Logo Usage for Gatherings

Gatherings are member-led, so there's no fixed logo. Historically, organizers have paired the InnerSource Commons logo with a simple wordmark that anchors the event to its location and year:



InnerSource Gathering **Tokyo** 2026

Example – Tokyo location word uses red from the Japanese flag

Example Image from 2025 Tokyo Gathering



InnerSource Gathering
Tokyo 2025

The Pattern

ISC logo + "InnerSource Gathering [Location] [Year]". Keep the logo and wordmark on the same baseline with comfortable horizontal spacing between them.

The Location Color

The location word is set in a standout color drawn from the **host country's flag** – e.g. **red** for Tokyo (Japan), **green** for Lagos, (Nigeria) **Schwarz-Rot-Gold** for Berlin (Germany), **blue or red** for London (UK). This gives each Gathering a distinct local identity while keeping the overall mark consistent.

LET'S BUILD THIS TOGETHER

Ready to host a Gathering?



Slack

#local-community



Email

community@innersourcecommons.org



Docs

innersourcecommons.org/gatherings